# CS-000 Documentation Standards, Template & Revision Process

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| **Doc ID** | CS-000 |
| **Title** | Documentation Standards, Template & Revision Process |
| **Revision** | B |
| **Status** | Draft, pending Lead signature |
| **Effective date** | 2026-07-28 |
| **Supersedes** | Ad-hoc SN5 documentation practice |

### Approvals

| Role | Name | Date |
|---|---|---|
| Author | Simon Starbuck (drafted with Claude, SN6 Resources) | 2026-07-12 |
| Reviewer | simon (reviewer agent) | |
| Approver (Composites Lead) | | |

### Revision history

| Rev | Date | Author | Description of change |
|---|---|---|---|
| A | 2026-07-12 | Claude | Initial issue |
| B | 2026-07-28 | Claude | Language pass: fewer em dashes for rhythm variety, no content change. |

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## 1. Purpose

We built good stuff in SN5 and barely wrote any of it down properly: not one doc had a revision number, changelog, or approver, and "what stack did the seat use last year?" was answerable only by whoever happened to remember (PP-09). This doc is how we name, structure, revise, and approve our documents so the knowledge outlives whoever wrote it. On a student team, turnover isn't a risk, it's a schedule.

## 2. Scope

All controlled composites documents: CS-XXX standards, work orders (WO-SNx-###), and formal deliverables (test reports, RCA docs). It does not control meeting notes, Slack threads, or scratch R&D notes, but any conclusion from those that the team relies on must graduate into a controlled doc.

## 3. References

| Ref | Document | Where |
|---|---|---|
| R1 | SN5 Pain Points & Improvements, PP-09 | `01 Pain Points and Improvements/` |
| R2 | CS-Template | `02 CS Standards/template/CS-Template.md` (+ .docx) |

| Ref | Document | Where |
|---|---|---|
| R3 | CS-013 Work Orders & Part Traceability | CS-013 |

## 4. Definitions

- **Controlled document** — a document with a Doc ID, revision letter, and named approver; the team treats its current released revision as the way work is done.
- **CS-XXX** — a Composites Standard, numbered CS-000 through CS-999. The number never changes once assigned, even if the title is edited.
- **Revision** — letters, starting at A. Any change to procedure content bumps the revision; typo fixes may be batched into the next content revision.
- **Status** — Draft, pending Lead signature (written and reviewed but unsigned: usable as guidance, not yet the rule), Released (current practice; approver row signed), Under Revision (follow it, but changes are coming), Retired (kept for history; do not follow, its header must name the replacement). **A doc whose Approver row is blank is never Released, no exceptions.** The header must say so itself, because members read headers, not the INDEX footnotes.

## 5. Equipment & Materials

None — this is a process standard. Documents live in the team Drive under `Composites > Standards` (source + PDF/docx), and the master list is CS-INDEX.

## 6. Safety

No physical hazards — this is a process standard. (The section exists because every CS doc must carry one: CS-Template §6.)

## 7. Procedure

### 7.1 Creating a new standard

1. Check CS-INDEX for an existing standard covering the topic; extend rather than duplicate.
2. Copy CS-Template; take the next free CS number from CS-INDEX and add a row there with Status = Draft **immediately** (this reserves the number).
3. Write the draft. Every quantitative claim gets a source: a TDS/SDS in `04 Datasheets/` (add it and its INDEX row if missing), a test report, or a recorded team measurement (work order ID). “We’ve always done it this way” is not a source; if that’s all there is, say so explicitly in the text.
4. Get one reviewer who did NOT write the draft to walk the procedure mentally (or physically, for shop procedures) and comment.
5. The Composites Lead approves: name + date in the approval table, Status → Released, CS-INDEX updated.

### 7.2 Revising a standard

1. Anyone may propose a revision. The trigger that matters most is an incident: **if a part or mold is lost to a process failure, the relevant standard gets reviewed within two weeks** while memory is fresh, and either revised or explicitly re-affirmed in its changelog.
2. Set Status → Under Revision in CS-INDEX so users know changes are coming.
3. Make the change, add a revision-history row (what changed and *why* — one line each), bump the revision letter.
4. Same review + approval as 7.1. Announce released revisions in the weekly summary message.

### 7.3 Retiring a standard

1. Set Status → Retired in the doc header and CS-INDEX; state the replacement (a CS number, or "practice discontinued").
2. Never delete the file. Retired docs are the team's institutional memory (the Duratec story is worth more retired than deleted).

### 7.4 Annual handoff review

1. Each summer, the incoming lead skims every Released standard with the outgoing lead (budget ~2 hours total) and marks each: still right / needs revision / retire.
2. Findings go into CS-INDEX notes; revisions get scheduled, not just wished for.

   A standard nobody can find is a standard that doesn't exist. CS-INDEX is the single place that lists every document, its revision, and its status: keep it current at the moment of change, not "later".

## 8. Quality checks / acceptance criteria

| Check | Target | Method | Record where |
|---|---|---|---|
| Every released CS doc has ID, revision, approver, changelog | 100% | Skim headers | CS-INDEX |
| Quantitative claims cite a source | Every number traceable | Reviewer walk-through (7.1 step 4) | Review comment in doc |
| Post-incident review | Within 2 weeks of losing a part/mold | Lead checks at Monday meeting | Changelog row |
| Annual handoff review done | Before fall recruiting | Incoming lead | CS-INDEX notes |

## 9. Records

CS-INDEX is the record. Work orders (CS-013) record per-part execution; this standard records how the documents themselves are kept honest.

## Appendix: why this exists

SN5's two documentation tiers were formal deliverables (author + date, no versioning) and stub templates (often empty). Both rotted silently: the *Mold Sealer Alternatives* study (Oct 2025) recommended S120/water-based sealers, was overtaken by the XCR decision (Feb–Apr 2026), and nothing marked it superseded. A new member reading the Drive in July 2026 could not tell which document described current practice. Status fields and CS-INDEX exist to make "which doc is true" a lookup instead of an archaeology project.